

SOC 2 Workbook

Best Practices, Tips and Tricks

Introduction

Obtaining a SOC 2 Type 2 report is a comprehensive and often lengthy process. For early-stage organizations who are new to compliance, it can take well over a year, as the work required to achieve the report is both daunting and laborious. With all of the time and effort needed to obtain SOC 2 compliance, it's no wonder that many organizations quickly become overwhelmed and frustrated.

Hyperproof aims to minimize the stress that comes with the process of obtaining a SOC 2 Type 2 report. Your purchase of Hyperproof comes with a tailored SOC 2 template put together by our team of experts. It's designed to help drastically reduce the time and effort it takes for your organization to hit the ground running. This template provides an implementation structure within Hyperproof to help you more quickly document all controls and gather all of the compliance artifacts needed to pass your SOC 2 assessment. Our platform is also designed to help your organization effectively and efficiently manage all the work you'll need to do to maintain your controls on an ongoing basis.

In addition to the template, Hyperproof provides a **workbook** with recommendations for reusing evidence across multiple controls, managing the health of your controls, and performing these tasks in Hyperproof. We based the workbook on the experiences of multiple Hyperproof customers who have gone through the SOC 2 process. The workbook works best for organizations that are just beginning their compliance journey or plan to use Hyperproof's SOC 2 template with limited modifications. Even if you modify the template, the workbook can still be a valuable reference.

There are many ways to manage your SOC 2 program. The attached workbook provides one way, and is simply a recommendation of best practices when it comes to using Hyperproof to achieve your SOC 2 compliance. It's important to note that the workbook may or may not be a good fit for your organization. Keep in mind that your SOC 2 auditor will review your controls in the context of your business as part of a gap analysis. Depending on the results of the gap analysis, your SOC 2 auditor may suggest that some of your controls need modifications or expansion.

Workbook Contents

The SOC 2 workbook contains six sheets:

1. **Setting Up Your SOC 2 Program** - A step-by-step guide for standing up your organization's SOC 2 program in Hyperproof.
2. **CSV of Labels** - In Hyperproof, labels are an effective tool used to manage and organize evidence efficiently. Labels function as folders, or buckets, for evidence that can be leveraged across multiple controls. In the workbook you'll find a list of 19 of our customers' most frequently used SOC 2 labels with linked controls. This list needs to be downloaded as a CSV and then imported into Hyperproof.
3. **Control Management** - A list of recommended Hyperproof settings per control type to keep your controls healthy. This ensures that you are reviewing your controls regularly to confirm that they are being properly executed upon, and that the evidence that reflects this is being collected. We recommend which Hyperproof feature to use and when, as well as the best practices for using this feature in a SOC 2 program.
4. **Policy Documents** - A list of templates for SOC 2-relevant policy and procedure documents.
5. **Glossary** - A list of clearly defined, commonly used Hyperproof and SOC 2-related terms.
6. **Help Resources** - A list of links to relevant help center articles in case you need help with a particular task.

Workbook Workflow

The SOC 2 workbook is meant to be followed chronologically. Before you do anything with SOC 2, you'll need to set up your SOC 2 program. Next, you'll import the CSV of labels into Hyperproof. Labels help you keep your evidence organized and are mapped to the most common illustrative controls needed to satisfy SOC 2 requirements. After the CSV of labels is imported into Hyperproof, you'll begin to manage your SOC 2 controls. The Control Management sheet outlines the controls you need to adhere to, their matching requirements, and the recommended method or methods of how they could be managed. Managing your controls is crucial in becoming SOC 2 compliant—taking the time to set them up now saves you ample time in the long run.

Creating Your SOC 2 Program

The first step to take towards achieving your SOC 2 Type 2 report is to stand up your organization's SOC 2 program. In order to get the most out of the SOC 2 workbook, you'll need to include the controls provided by Hyperproof. Once your program is up and running, you'll import the CSV of labels.

Importing the CSV

Labels in Hyperproof allow you to easily reuse evidence across multiple controls. This means that you don't have to upload the same piece of evidence 10 times and link it to 10 different controls. Instead, you'll upload the evidence once and link it to the appropriate label. You'll then link the label to the relevant controls in a one-time exercise.

The workbook comes with a list of 19 suggested labels that are commonly used in many of our customers' SOC 2 programs. The labels in the CSV already have the corresponding controls linked, so there's no need for additional work. How you upload evidence is up to you, but the easiest and most efficient way to do this is via a Hypersync or LiveSync.

For information about importing labels into Hyperproof, please refer to the article [Importing Labels](#).

Managing Controls

In order to pass your assessment to obtain a SOC 2 Type 2 report, you need to demonstrate that your controls were implemented and had been operating effectively over a period of time; a typical time frame for controls evaluation is over a six to twelve months window for SOC 2 Type 2. Practically speaking, you need to set up a mechanism to monitor your controls to ensure they remain effective over a six or twelve month(s) period and gather evidence to prove that controls have been functioning. Taking the time now to set up continuous control management drastically reduces your workload as well as the time it takes to obtain the SOC 2 Type 2 report. Hyperproof offers several ways to manage your control health.

Review the terms below to familiarize yourself with the different methods Hyperproof offers for control management.

Freshness

You can use the concept of freshness to manage the status of controls, and to track whether they are up-to-date and in compliance with the requirements in your SOC 2 program. When you turn on freshness for a control, you define its expiration period at the end of which its freshness status will automatically change from *Fresh* to *Expired*.

A note about freshness: For extra assurance, you can use freshness in conjunction with another control management method, e.g. you can use freshness and a repeating task on the same control.

EXAMPLE You might use the Freshness feature to manage SOC2-CC7.5.3 (annually test incident response plan) by turning on freshness and setting it to expire in 365 days. All *members of the control* will receive an email notification 24 hours prior to the expiration date. Additionally, the *Needs Attention* section of the Hyperproof dashboard alerts control members a month prior to the expiration date.

For information about using the Freshness feature on a control, please refer to the article [Control Freshness](#).

Repeating Task

You may want to set up a repeating task for actions that you have to perform over and over again. For example, if you have to manually review a particular control each month, you can set up a schedule-based repeating task to remind yourself to perform the review each month.

EXAMPLE You might use a schedule-based repeating task to manage SOC2-CC1.5.2 (monthly performance review meetings for departments with internal control responsibilities) because this is a task that you need to perform each month.

For information on creating repeating tasks, please refer to the article [Creating a Repeating Task via the Automations Tab](#).

LiveSync

LiveSync is a great option if the evidence you want to collect is in the format of an ongoing document, such as a Google Doc. Evidence must be stored in an external cloud management platform such as Drive or Dropbox in order for LiveSync to work. Once you've connected your external cloud management platform to Hyperproof, you can link evidence stored there to controls, labels, or tasks.

EXAMPLE You might use the LiveSync feature to manage SOC2-CC3.2.3 (respond to risks via meetings with IT personnel) because the meeting notes are maintained in an ongoing Google Doc.

For information on using LiveSync to manage controls, please refer to the article [Using LiveSync](#).

Hypersync

Evidence that is generated by an external cloud-based service or app, like AWS or Azure, can be linked to Hyperproof via a Hypersync. Rather than continuously uploading new evidence each time it changes, you can create a Hypersync that automates the process. Hypersyncs can be set up on controls or labels.

Example: You might use a Hypersync to manage SOC2-CC6.4.2 (annually review access to data centers) because the evidence you need to provide to satisfy the control's requirement is maintained and stored in an external service app such as AWS.

For information on how to connect to an external service app and create a Hypersync, please refer to the article [Hypersync Overview](#). Specific service-app related information can be found in the left menu of the Hyperproof Help Center.

In the SOC 2 workbook, you'll find recommendations for methods that work best with certain controls. Remember, how you choose to manage your SOC 2 controls is up to you. You may find yourself using a mix of the methods above, or you might find yourself using the same method for each control. What's important is that your controls are, in fact, being managed throughout your SOC 2 compliance journey.

Final Thoughts

We at Hyperproof designed the SOC 2 workbook to help as many of our customers as possible. Our goal is to help you reduce your workload, improve productivity, and alleviate the stress that often comes with the SOC 2 compliance journey. We hope you find the workbook helpful, and that you feel confident using Hyperproof to manage your SOC 2 compliance journey. Please feel free to share your feedback regarding this workbook and/or your SOC 2 journey at customer_success@hyperproof.io.

[Click here to access Hyperproof's SOC 2 workbook.](#)